

Authority Delegation Standard - (ADS)

OriginID: OOF-OID-AGA-ADS-2026-06-14-0003

Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™

Architecture Family: Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™)

Operational Layer: Authority Delegation Governance Layer

Governed Space: Authority Delegation Governance

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Accountability Governance Architecture

Type: Parent Standard

Version: 1.0

Status: Canonical · Open Standard

Origin Date: 14 June 2026

Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS · Accountability Governance

Architecture (AGA™) · Relationship Accountability

Standard (RAS) · Authority Governance Standard (AGS) · Authority

Validation Standard (AVS) · Authority Escalation

Standard (AES) · Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS) ·

INTEGROS® — Integrity Standard

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF

Protection: MIP — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition System

Canonical Definition

Authority Delegation Standard (ADS) defines the structural conditions under which authority may be delegated, transferred, assigned, distributed, inherited, accepted, exercised, governed, and reconstructed while preserving legitimacy, traceability, accountability, continuity, and operational validity throughout the delegation lifecycle.

ADS governs authority delegation.

The standard establishes the foundational conditions required to determine how authority moves between actors and whether delegated authority remains valid throughout operational environments.

Authority rarely operates through a single actor.

Authority is frequently delegated.

ADS governs whether that delegation remains valid.

A. Standard Abstract

Modern operational systems depend on delegated authority.

Organizations delegate authority.

Institutions delegate authority.

Governments delegate authority.

Contractor networks delegate authority.

AI orchestration systems delegate authority.

Autonomous systems increasingly operate through delegated authority structures.

Without governance:

- authority may become fragmented
- authority may become unclear
- authority may exceed its intended scope
- accountability may disappear
- delegation chains may become unreconstructable

ADS exists to govern these conditions.

B. Core Principle

Authority delegation becomes valid only when delegated authority remains legitimate, traceable, accountable, reconstructable, continuous, governable, and operationally valid throughout the delegation lifecycle.

C. Scope

This standard may apply to:

- organizations
- institutions
- governments
- management structures
- supervisory environments
- contractor networks
- subcontractor environments
- delegated governance structures
- AI systems
- autonomous agents
- orchestrated agent systems
- Human-AI environments
- robotics ecosystems
- distributed operational systems
- future intelligent governance architectures

ADS applies wherever authority moves from one actor to another.

D. Why This Standard Exists

Most operational systems function through authority delegation.

Authority often originates at one level but is exercised at another.

Examples include:

- executive to manager
- manager to supervisor
- supervisor to worker
- organization to contractor
- contractor to subcontractor
- human to AI system
- orchestration layer to AI agent
- AI agent to execution system

As authority moves through operational environments, governance visibility often decreases.

The challenge is not creating authority.

The challenge is preserving trustworthy authority delegation.

ADS exists because authority delegation has become a distinct governance space.

E. Authority Delegation Integrity Logic

Authority delegation integrity exists only when the following remain materially preservable:

1. Authority Delegation Origin Integrity

Delegation remains attributable to a legitimate authority source.

2. Authority Delegation Scope Integrity

Delegated authority remains bounded by clearly identifiable limits.

3. Authority Delegation Validity Integrity

Delegation remains legitimate, accepted, and operationally valid.

4. Authority Delegation Continuity Integrity

Delegation remains traceable throughout transfer, change, escalation, inheritance, or succession.

5. Authority Delegation Accountability Integrity

Delegated authority remains connected to accountable governance structures.

F. Operational Architecture Space

ADS defines the operational architecture space for:

- authority delegation governance
- delegated authority structures
- authority transfer
- authority assignment
- authority distribution
- authority inheritance
- authority continuity
- delegation accountability
- Human-AI delegation governance
- agent delegation governance
- distributed authority systems

This space exists because authority increasingly operates through delegation rather than direct execution.

ADS governs whether that delegation remains valid.

G. Difference Between Authority and Authority

Delegation

Authority defines the legitimate right to act.

Authority delegation defines the legitimate transfer of that right.

Authority may exist without delegation.

Delegation cannot exist without authority.

AGS governs authority.

ADS governs movement of authority.

Both are required.

H. Runtime Position

ADS operates as the third foundational layer of AGA™.

It follows:

- Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)
 - Authority Governance Standard (AGS)
-

and supports:

- Authority Validation Standard (AVS)
- Authority Escalation Standard (AES)
- Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS)
- Capability Readiness Governance Standard (CRGS)
- Chain of Control Standard (CCS)

ADS governs how authority moves through governance systems.

I. Authority Delegation Failure Rule

Authority delegation failure occurs when delegated authority cannot be reliably traced, validated, reconstructed, governed, or connected to legitimate authority structures.

Examples include:

- undocumented delegation
- invalid delegation
- excessive delegation
- unauthorized delegation
- accountability loss
- hidden delegation chains
- governance-blind authority transfer
- delegation ambiguity

ADS exists to expose and govern these conditions.

J. Validity Logic

An authority-delegation environment is valid under ADS when:

- delegation remains identifiable
- delegation origin remains traceable
- delegation scope remains visible
- delegation validity remains verifiable
- delegation continuity remains reconstructable
- delegation accountability remains preservable
- delegated authority remains governable

An authority-delegation environment becomes invalid when:

- delegation origin is unknown
- delegation legitimacy cannot be validated
- delegation exceeds its scope
- delegation continuity is lost

- accountability disappears
- delegated authority cannot be reconstructed

K. Relationship to Other OOF Standards

ADS derives from:

- Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)
- Authority Governance Standard (AGS)

and supports:

- Authority Validation Standard (AVS)
- Authority Escalation Standard (AES)
- Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS)
- Capability Readiness Governance Standard (CRGS)
- Chain of Control Standard (CCS)
- Governance Oversight Standard (GOS)
- Accountability Governance Standard (AGS-A)

AGS governs authority.

ADS governs how authority moves between actors.

L. Foundational Principle

Authority may be delegated, but governance responsibility for delegated authority must remain reconstructable.

Canonical Closing Statement

Authority Delegation Standard (ADS) defines the structural conditions under which authority may be delegated, transferred, assigned, distributed, inherited, accepted, exercised, governed, and reconstructed while preserving legitimacy, traceability, accountability, continuity, and operational validity throughout the delegation lifecycle.

Authority increasingly operates through delegation. If delegated authority cannot be traced, validated, bounded, or reconstructed, governance loses visibility into who possessed the right to act. Authority delegation governance therefore becomes a foundational condition of trustworthy governance systems.

Mahlad

Module Architecture

→ ADOIM — Authority Delegation Origin Integrity Module

→ ADSIM — Authority Delegation Scope Integrity Module

→ ADVIM — Authority Delegation Validity Integrity Module

→ ADCIM — Authority Delegation Continuity Integrity Module

→ ADAIM — Authority Delegation Accountability Integrity Module

Related Documents

→ About the Authority Delegation Standard - (ADS)

OOF® MIP® Protection Notice

OOF® · Protected under MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

Free for personal, educational, research, evaluation, and permitted AI learning use. Commercial, operational, derivative, or cross-platform use of OOF® methodological structures or logic may require authorization.

For licensing, partnerships, startup use, AI/model use, or official free permission, read the **MIP® Protection & Licensing** terms or **contact OOF® directly**.

Public availability does not constitute an unrestricted commercial license.

Active Protection & Compatibility Detection applies.

Canonical Source

<https://originopenfoundation.org/>